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Late blight: *Phytophthora infestans*

Symptoms

- Water-soaked black lesions on leaves and stems
- Lesions expand rapidly and the entire leaf becomes necrotic.
- White sporulation (sporangia and sporangiophores) on leaves.

Fruit

- Dark brown lesions on fruit
- Soft rot and disintegration of fruits.



Symptoms on leaves



Fruit infection



Sporangiophores and sporangium



Oospore

Causal organism

- *Phytophthora infestans* (Mont.) de Bary

Asexual spores :

- Indeterminate sporangiophores, Zoospores: Biflagellate with one tinsel flagellum directed anteriorly and one whiplash flagellum directed posteriorly

Pathogen:

- Hyaline and coenocytic

Sexual spores :

- Thick-walled oospore

Survival and Mode of Spread

Survival :

- Infected Debris

Primary spread:

- Infected debris

Secondary spread:

- Wind

Favourable conditions :

- Cool nights, warm days and extended wet conditions from rain and fog
- Sporangia formed when RH is < 90%
- Optimum temp for sporulation is 18 - 22°C

Integrated Disease Management:

- Proper drainage
- Crop rotation
- Soil application of *Trichoderma asperellum* (viride) @ 1.0 kg/ac
- Spray Cyazofamid 34.5% SC @ 80 ml/ac or Azoxystrobin 23% SC @ 200 ml/ac or Mancozeb 35% SC @ 1000 g/ac or Zineb 75% WP @ 800 g/ac or Azoxystrobin 18.2%+ Difenoconazole 11.4% SC @ 200 ml/ac

Source of Information

<https://www.apsnet.org>.

Crop production guide – Horticulture 2020

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